

Title: Design A — Sequential Stepper | **Sheet No:** Sheet #2
Author: Bharath Arun Gandhimani | **Date:** 12/05/2026
Description: Fully author-driven interactive narrative visualisation communicating findings about educational infrastructure investment, socioeconomic equity, and household travel behaviour in Victoria. Targeted at policymakers and transport planners. Reader progresses through a fixed 7-step sequence — one analytical layer per step.

The stepper enforces a deliberate reading order — investment geography is established first before socioeconomic or behavioural patterns are introduced. This prevents a policymaker from jumping to conclusions without the geographic context that frames the entire argument. Chart types (choropleth, slope chart, lollipop) are drawn from Sheet 1 Ideas #7, #6, and the geographic/map category respectively. No filters or dropdowns — narrative control stays with the author.

[F] Step 4 of 7 — Mode Share Shift Across Investment Tiers
 [D] Chart Zone (60% content)

Mode	Low Inv.	High Inv.
PV	56%	74%
PT	34%	18%
Act	10%	8%

■ Private Vehicle ■ Public Transport ■ Active

[E] Narrative Text Zone (40% content)

[A] Step Indicator [B] Next Button [C] Previous Button [D] Chart Zone [E] Narrative Text [F] Step Heading

[C] ← Previous **[B] Next →**

OTHER STEPS

Step 1 — Title Frame
 Title / Framing Question

Step 2 — Choropleth
 Choropleth — Investment by LGA

Step 3 — Lollipop
 Lollipop — LGA Project Count

Step 4 (Active) — Slope Chart
 Slope Chart — Mode Share Shift

Step 5 — Grouped Bar
 Grouped Bar — Vehicle Ownership

Step 6 — Scatter
 Scatter — IRSD vs Mode Share

Step 7 — Closing
 Closing — 29-LGA Gap + Policy

29-LGA Gap Callout
 Investment recorded, no VISTA data
 Data sources + Restart

[B] Click "Next →"

Content in [D] and [E] fades out. Next step's chart and narrative text fade in. Step indicator [A] advances — current circle fills solid grey (visited), next circle activates black. On the final step the Next button is replaced by a "Restart" option.

[C] Click "← Previous"

Returns to the prior step. [A] updates to reflect the previous active step. [C] is hidden when the reader is on Step 1 — there is no "before" the opening frame.

[A] Click a visited step circle

Jumps directly to that completed step for review. Unvisited future circles remain greyed out and unclickable — the reader cannot skip ahead to content they have not yet reached.

[D] Hover on chart element

A tooltip appears showing exact values — percentage, count, LGA name. This is the only interactivity within a step. No filters, no dropdowns, no view changes are available.

[A] Step circle — state logic

Visited circles show filled grey. Active circle shows filled black. Unvisited future circles show white with light grey border and are unclickable. State maintained for the full session.

Step 7 — Final step reached

The 29-LGA gap callout and policy implication text are revealed. Data source links and a "Restart" button appear. The [B] Next button is hidden. Reader has completed the full narrative arc.

Indicator State: N active

Indicator State: N+1 active

Click Next

Fade out / Fade in

Each step reveals exactly one analytical layer. Reader cannot skip ahead but can revisit visited circles [A]

Step Circle States

- Visited — filled grey
- Active — filled black
- Locked — white, unclickable

Label Reference

[A] Step Indicator
 [B] Next Button
 [C] Previous Button
 [D] Chart Zone
 [E] Narrative Text
 [F] Step Heading

The closing step only makes sense once all prior evidence has been absorbed — this is what separates Design A from B and C. Chart types per step: Step 2 → Choropleth (geographic category, Sheet 1); Step 3 → Lollipop (Sheet 1 Idea #6); Step 4 → Slope Chart (Sheet 1 Idea #7).

Pros	Cons
• Sees evidence in exact order as intended — no confusion about where to start. • One chart, one explanation per step keeps things simple and focused for a non-technical policymaker audience.	• Cannot compare two charts side by side — reader must go back and forth between visited steps.

- Opens with geographic framing (choropleth). Closes with what remains unknown (29-LGA gap). Clean narrative arc.
- Works well with non-technical audiences like policymakers who need framing before data.
- Easy to implement in R Shiny using a reactive step counter with conditional panel rendering.
- Hover tooltips as the sole interactivity keeps implementation scope controlled and avoids cognitive overload.

- Feels passive — no filters, no exploration, just clicking Next. Transport planners who are data-savvy may find it too hand-holdy.
- Reader may lose interest if any single step does not feel immediately relevant to their concern.
- Readers who already understand the context must still sit through the opening framing step.
- Step count of 7 is on the upper boundary — risk of fatigue before reaching the policy implication in Step 7.